IMC427: DIGITAL MEDIA ACTIVATION

BLICK

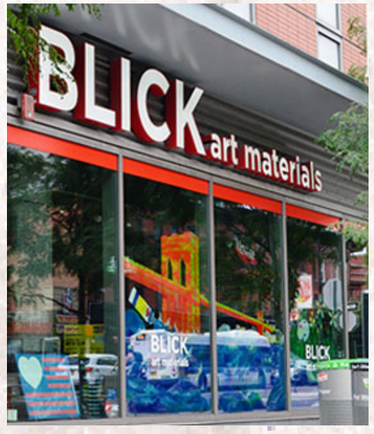
Presenter: Minko Ma

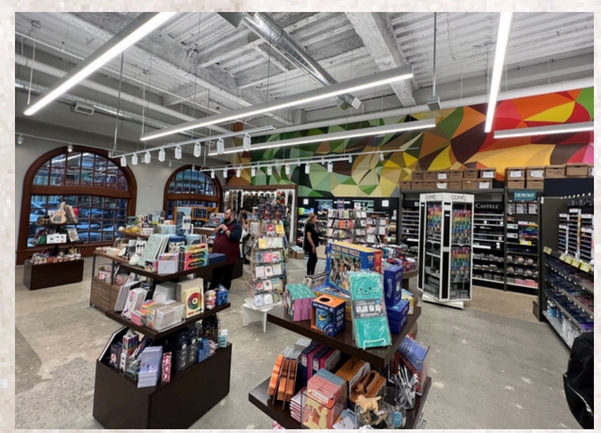
BRAND INTRO

BLICK®
art materials

Blick Art Materials is America's oldest and largest family-owned art supply retailer. Founded in 1911 as a small mail-order business and now operating more than 60 retail stores across 23 states.

The company is commited to provide **artists, educators, students, and hobbyists** with the tools, assistance, and training needed to grow, innovate, and reach their creative potential.





KEY PRODUCT LINES

Paint & Mediums

Canvas & Surfaces

Brushes & Painting Tools

Drawing & Illustration

Papers & Boards

Crafts & Textiles

External Environment: Key Competitors

Michaels

- Wide product range
- Private-label product line, aggressive pricing (targets hobbyists/casual creators)
- Mass-market appeal and in-store promotions lead to accessibility
- Strong social media appeal

amazon

- Wide range of product offerings through first and third party sellers
- Highly competitive prices, expedited, convenient shipping
- Algorithm-driven recommendations, user reviews

HOBBY LOBBY

- Frequent discounts, in-store promotions, cable TV ads
- Arts, crafts, home decor supplies, heavy emphasis on DIY, seasonal, and budget materials
- Positioned toward casual, budget-conscious hobbyists and home crafters vs. Blick's professional artist base

INTERNAL & EXTERNAL CHALLENGAES

INTERNAL

- **Limited in-store footprint:** only 60+ stores across 23 states vs. Michaels' 1,300+ locations
- **In-store experience hindered** by understaffing (emphasis on product knowledge), reducing service quality
- **Low brand awareness among casual consumers:** total social audience of 938K vs. Michaels' 5.4M
- **No dedicated mobile app**, limiting convenience compared to competitors
- **Lower ad spend constrains reach:** $39K vs. Michaels' $327K (Vivvix)

EXTERNAL

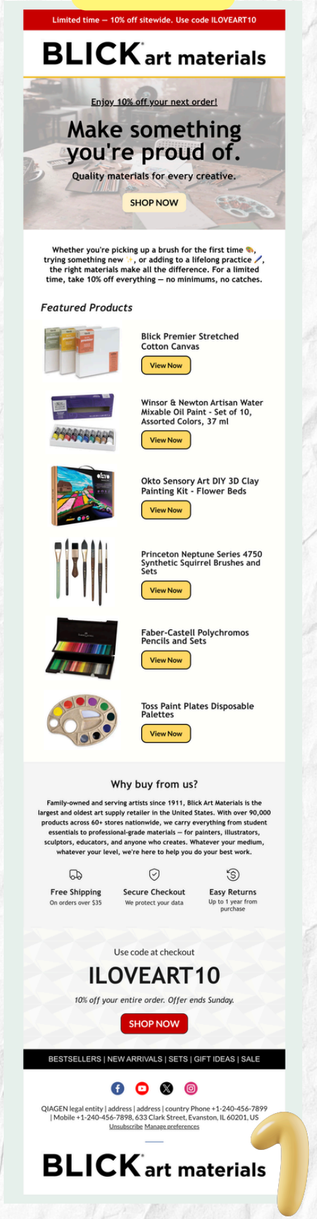
- **Strong competition** from Michaels, Amazon, and Hobby Lobby across price, convenience, and reach
- **Growing adoption of digital art tools** (Procreate, Adobe) may reduce demand for traditional supplies
- **Economic downturns reduce discretionary spending** on art supplies
- **Consumer preference shifting** toward online convenience and fast delivery (Amazon Prime)
- **Rising digital ad costs** squeezing paid media ROI for specialty retailers

OWNED MEDIA

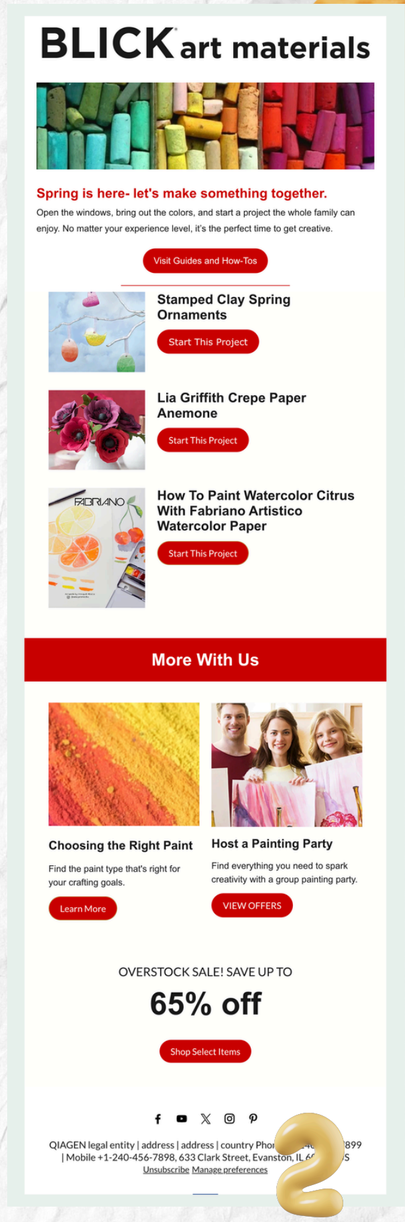
Metric	Campaign 1	Campaign 2	Campaign 3
Sent/Delivered	59/59	54/54	65/65
Open Rate	49.15%	38.89%	7.69%
Click Rate	6.78%	7.41%	4.62%
CTR	13.79%	19.05%	60%
Read	10.30%	4.80%	20%
Glanced	86.20%	95.20%	80%

Note: Campaign 3 showed abnormal performance data (very low open rate), so its later metrics may be less reliable due to small sample size.

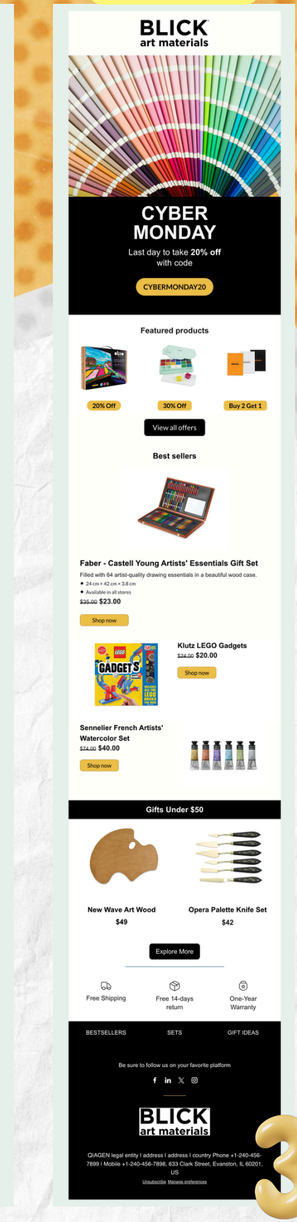
Your next masterpiece starts here — 10% off sitewide



Get Creative This Week with BLICK



🎨Cyber Monday - Save 20% at Blick Art Materials!



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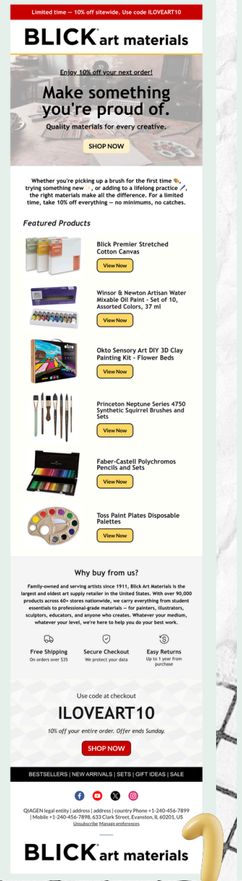
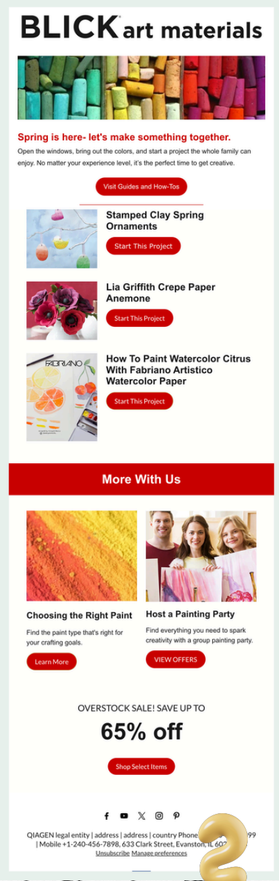
KEY LEARNINGS

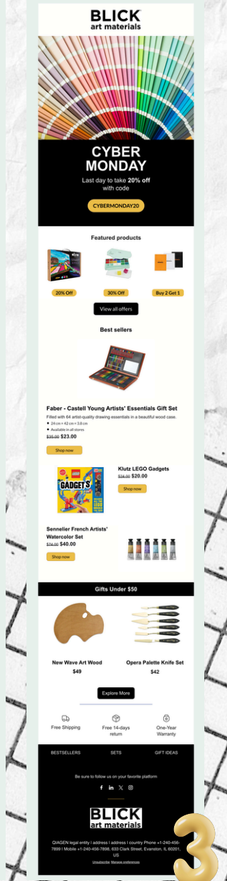
- **Email performance data should be interpreted collectively** rather than evaluating individual metrics in isolation
- **Clear promotional messaging and value proposition** drove higher open rates
- **Inspirational content generated stronger click-thru engagement**

RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Combine inspiration with promotional value,** blend creative storytelling with clearer discounts or incentives earlier in the email
- **Simplify layout and strengthen CTAs,** use cleaner hierarchy, fewer competing sections, and more visible CTA buttons
- **Improve testing and segmentation,** conduct A/B testing on subject lines and send times to better optimize audience engagement







PAID MEDIA

KEYWORDS

Keyword	Estimated Traffic	Avg CPC	Proj Revenue
blick	135,000	$ 0.2	$8,100
blick art materials	60,500	$ 0.4	$3,630
art supplies	40,500	$ 0.8	$2,430

ROI: 7.5x | Conversion Rate: 3% | AOV: $100

LEARNINGS & RECOMMENDATIONS

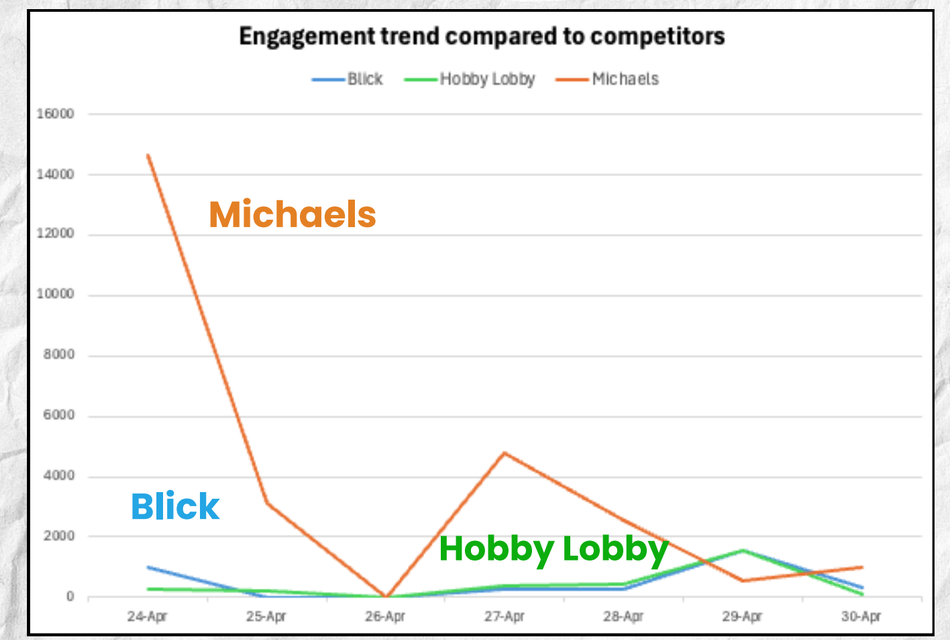
- **Branded keywords drive 83% of projected revenue at lower CPCs**, reflecting strong brand loyalty among Blick's core audience of professional artists and students
- **Anchor campaign budget on branded keywords** for maximum ROAS and set a CPC threshold for "art supplies"
- **Continuously test ad copy and landing pages** to improve efficiency and convert first-time browsers into loyal Blick customers

EARNED MEDIA

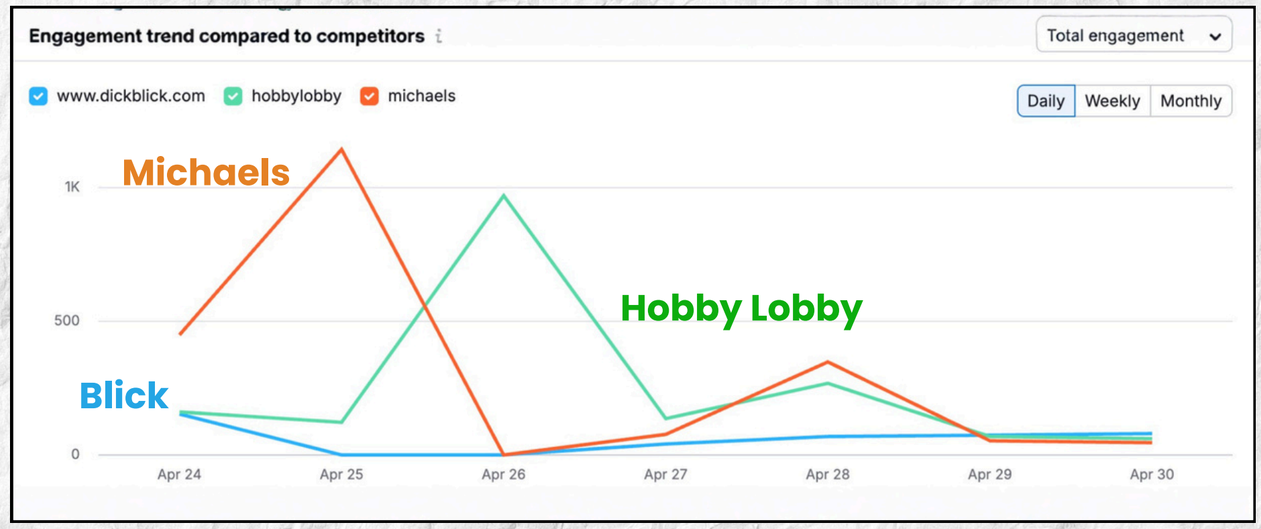
COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Compared to Michaels, Blick generates significantly lower engagement despite similar posting frequency, while Hobby Lobby emains more comparable in IG and occasionally outperforms Blick in Facebook engagement.

Time Range: April 24 - April 30



Instagram engagement chart (manual)



Facebook engagement chart (Semrush)

EARNED MEDIA

OVERVIEW

Blick maintains an active presence across 7 platforms. Strongest followings on Instagram (499K) and Facebook (368K). Twitter/X has been inactive since July 2024.

KEY LEARNINGS

- **Engagement performance varied by platform,** with Instagram showing the strongest overall audience engagement while YouTube, Pinterest, and LinkedIn appeared underutilized
- **Tutorial and creator-led content** drives higher engagement than product posts
- **Current social strategies have limited interactive and community-based features**, reducing opportunities for long-term audience retention

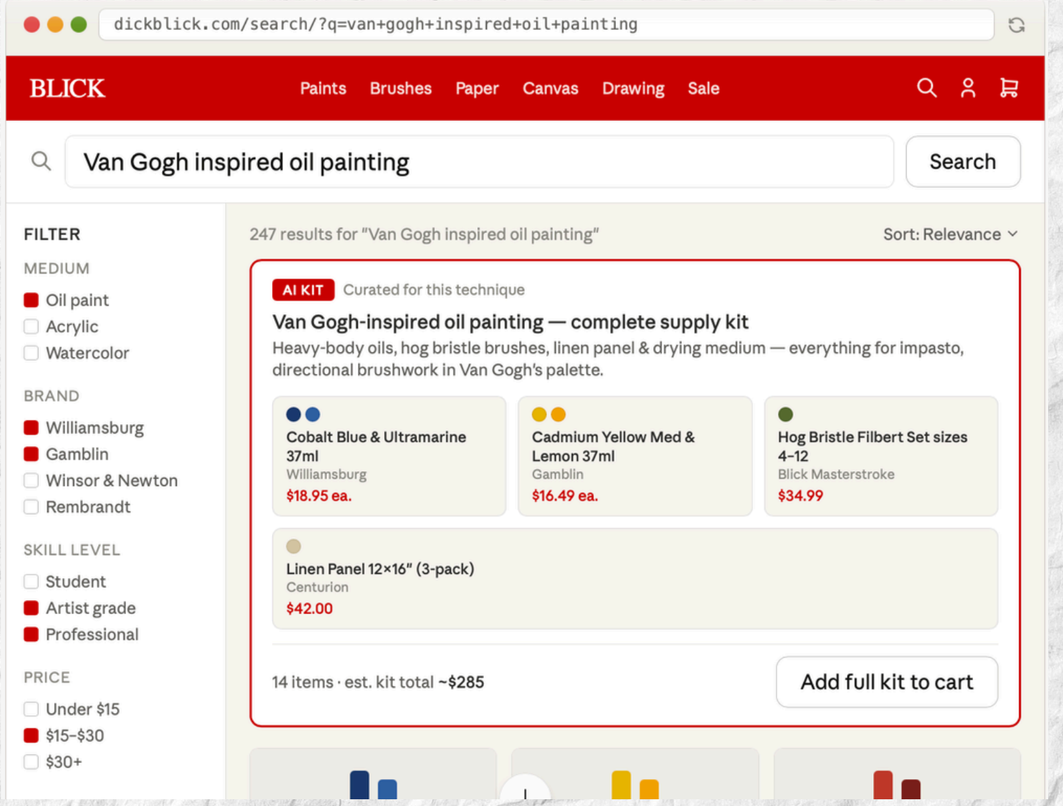
RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Prioritize Instagram and educational content** to strengthen engagement
- **Expand influencer partnerships** to increase authenticity and organic reach
- **Invest in UGC and interactive features** to support platform-specific strategies and build long-term community loyalty

EMERGING TECH

GENERATIVE AI-BUILT PRODUCT KITS

- Blick's core advantage is artist expertise- can be used to attract DIY-focused customers
- Instead of "customers also bought" algorithms, Blick could use a **generative AI layer** built by artist recommendations that builds project kits
- Customers could then filter by price, skill level, preferred brands, etc



THANK YOU!